USER'S MANUAL · VERSION 0.2.0

Vault — Financial Command Center

Vault is a desktop budgeting app for people paid twice a month. It plans every bill and loan installment against the paycheck that will cover it, tracks the money in each of your accounts, and keeps everything on your own computer.

Windows desktop app Amounts in Philippine pesos (₱)

Paydays: 15th and end of month

Vault Manual

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01 Getting started

Install Vault

1. Run `Vault_0.2.0_x64-setup.exe`. An `.msi` installer is also available if you prefer that format.
2. If Windows shows `Windows protected your PC`, click `More info` then `Run anyway`. This appears because the installer isn't digitally signed, which is normal for an app built yourself.
3. Open **Vault** from the Start Menu. The window is titled **Financial Command Center**.

Unlock your vault

The first screen asks for a **profile name**. Each profile name is its own separate vault with its own accounts, bills, and loans.

1. Type your profile name, for example `rc` or `Juan Dela Cruz`.
2. Click `🔒 Unlock Vault`. A new name creates a new, empty vault; a name you've used before opens that vault.
3. If any recurring bills due in the next 10 days still have no amount, a reminder lists them so you can enter the amounts from your billing statements.

> CHECK YOUR SPELLING
>
> Profile names aren't case-sensitive, and spaces become underscores, so `Juan Dela Cruz` and `juan dela cruz` open the same vault. But a typo like `Juan Dela Curz` quietly creates a brand-new empty vault. If your data seems to be missing, log out and check the name.

> NOT A PASSWORD
>
> The profile name only picks which vault to open. Anyone who can use your Windows account and knows the name can open it. Protect the computer itself with your Windows sign-in.

Find your way around

The bar at the top of every screen has the five sections of the app, your vault name, and two controls:

BUTTON	WHAT IT DOES
🏠 Dashboard	Your totals and what's coming up next. Section 03
💰 Cash Flow	Your accounts, income, expenses, transfers, and transaction history. Section 04
🗓️ Bi-Monthly Budget	Every unpaid bill, grouped by the paycheck that pays it. Section 05
📉 Loan Generator	Add loans and generate their payment schedules. Section 06
🔍 Search	Find any bill, loan, or amount. Section 07
🔄 Refresh	Reloads the current screen with the latest numbers.
🔒 Log Out	Locks the vault and returns to the profile screen.

02 Key ideas

Vault is built around a few ideas. Knowing them makes every screen easier to understand.

Paychecks and allocations

Vault assumes you're paid on the **15th** and at the **end of the month**. Every unpaid bill is **allocated** to one paycheck: the paycheck whose money will pay that bill. On the Bi-Monthly Budget screen, each paycheck gets its own tab listing its bills and their total.

The 10-day safety gap

When Vault picks a paycheck for you, it chooses the **latest payday that lands at least 11 days before the due date**. That leaves a 10-day cushion between getting paid and the bill being due. A bill due on November 20 is allocated to the October 31 paycheck, not November 15, because November 15 is only 5 days early.

You can always override the choice: when previewing a loan's schedule, or later with the `Move` button on any bill.

Bi-monthly halves: Sinking Fund vs True Bi-Monthly

A monthly payment can be spread over both paychecks as a **1st Half** and a **2nd Half (Due)**. The 2nd Half falls on the real due date; the 1st Half is 15 days earlier. Vault supports two kinds:

	SINKING FUND	TRUE BI-MONTHLY
Real payments	One per month, on the 2nd Half's date	Two per month, one per half
1st Half	Saved into a savings account ("fund") so the money is set aside	Paid to the lender like any bill
2nd Half	Pays the *full* monthly amount, using the saved 1st Half plus this half	Pays only its own half
Use it for	Lenders that charge once a month, when you want to save half from each paycheck	Lenders that actually collect twice a month

Here is one month of a Sinking Fund loan with a ₱2,000.00 monthly payment due on November 20:

Oct 15 pay	Handle **1st Half** → 🛟 Save to Fund Moves ₱1,000 from your main account into your savings account	-1,000.00 main · +1,000.00 savings
Oct 31 pay	Handle **2nd Half (Due)** → 🏦 Pay Bank, click OK to auto-transfer Vault moves the saved ₱1,000 back, then pays the full ₱2,000 to the lender	-1,000.00 savings · -1,000.00 main
Nov 20	Due date Already paid. The loan's remaining balance went down by ₱2,000	Loan -2,000.00

Recurring bills and TBD amounts

A **recurring** bill (marked 🔁) comes back every month on the same day. When you pay it, next month's copy is created automatically with the amount set to **TBD**, because utility bills change every month. Enter the amount when the statement arrives; a bill can't be handled until it has one.

Receipts, Recycle Bins, and Undo

Very little in Vault is permanent. Paid bills become **receipts** you can undo; deleted bills, loans, and accounts go to a **Recycle Bin** you can restore from; and ordinary transactions can be undone from the history. To prevent accidents, only the 3 most recent items show an ↩ Undo button right away; older ones need Show undo first.

03 Dashboard

The Dashboard is a read-only overview. Nothing here can be changed; use it to see where you stand.

PANEL	WHAT IT SHOWS
Total Liquid Cash	The combined balance of all your accounts.
Total Remaining Debt	What's still owed across all active loans.
Next 5 Upcoming Bills	The five unpaid bills with the earliest due dates, with their paycheck allocations and a **total**. Bills still TBD show "TBD" and are counted separately, e.g. "+ 1 TBD bill not yet included".
Bi-Monthly Budget Summary	Every unpaid bill in a single table, sorted by due date.
Active Loans Summary	Each active loan's term, frequency, payment, and remaining balance.

> ABOUT HALVES
>
> Upcoming bills list each half separately at its listed amount, which is the money to set aside from that paycheck. A Sinking Fund 2nd Half actually pays double its listed amount, but half of that comes from the fund you already saved.

04 Cash Flow

Cash Flow is where your accounts live: bank accounts, e-wallets, cash, and savings funds. Every peso Vault moves goes through one of them.

Add an account

1. Under **Add New Account**, type a name such as `GCash`, `BPI`, or `Emergency Fund`.
2. Click `+ Add`. The account starts at `₱0.00`. Each name can only be used once.
3. Log an **Income** into it to set its starting balance.

> TIP
> Make a separate account for each savings fund you use with Sinking Fund loans. It keeps set-aside money from being spent by accident.

Log a transaction

Use the **Log Transaction** bar. Every field is required.

TYPE	EFFECT
`Income (+)`	Adds money to the account. Use it for salary, freelance pay, refunds, gifts.
`Expense (-)`	Takes money out. Use it for spending that isn't a bill, like groceries or load.
`Transfer (⇔)`	Moves money from one account to another. Pick the receiving account in the second dropdown. Vault refuses the transfer if the source account doesn't have enough.

The amount box adds thousands separators as you type, so `12500` becomes `12,500`. Write a short description (e.g. `Salary`, `Groceries`) so you can find it later in Search.

Transaction history

History shows **one account at a time**, starting with your first account. To switch, click an **account card** (the selected one is outlined in green) or one of the buttons above the list. Click `All Accounts` for the complete history across every account.

- Newest entries are at the top, with the date and time each was recorded.
- Transfers show both accounts, e.g. 🔁 **BPI** ➡️ **GCash**.
- Click `Load More Transactions` to see entries beyond the first 50.

Undo a transaction

Income, expenses, and transfers can be undone from the history. Undoing a transfer reverses both accounts. Undone entries stay in the list, faded and marked **(Undone)**, so you have a full record.

> **BILL PAYMENTS ARE UNDONE ELSEWHERE**
>
> Entries created by paying or funding bills (starting with `Paid:`, `Funded to Savings:`, and their refunds) have no Undo button here. Undo them from **Receipts** on the Bi-Monthly Budget screen, which also puts the bill back.

Delete an account

Click the 🗑 on an account card. Vault only deletes accounts that are empty; transfer out any remaining balance first.

05 Bi-Monthly Budget

This is the heart of Vault: every unpaid bill and loan installment, organized by the paycheck that will pay it.

Log a new bill

FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER
Bill Name	e.g. `Internet`, `Water`, `Rent`.
Amount (₱)	The bill amount. Optional for recurring bills: leave it blank and it shows as TBD.
Actual Due Date	The date the biller expects payment.
Paycheck Allocation	The payday whose money will pay it, e.g. Oct 31.
`🔁 Recurring Bill`	Tick for bills that repeat on the same day every month.
`Split into Bi-Monthly Halves`	Appears for recurring bills. Turns the bill into a Sinking Fund pair. See Split a recurring bill.

Click `Save Bill`. Vault rejects dates that don't exist on the calendar, like February 30.

Paycheck tabs

Each tab, such as `💼 October 31, 2026 BILLS`, holds the bills allocated to that paycheck, nearest due date first. **Total Tab Due** at the top is how much that paycheck needs to cover.

The controls on each bill

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
⚠️ TBD — Click to Enter Amount	Appears when a recurring bill has no amount yet. Type the amount and click ✓.
🖍️ Edit	Changes a recurring bill's amount.
Split	Splits a recurring bill into a 1st Half and 2nd Half (Due).
🗑️ Delete	Moves the bill to the Recycle Bin at the bottom of the screen.
🗓️ Move	Reassigns the bill to a different paycheck.
Handle Bill	Pays the bill or saves it to a fund. Greyed out while the amount is TBD.

Handle a bill

Click `Handle Bill` and choose one of two actions:

- 🏦 `Pay Bank (Lowers Debt)`: pays the bill from the account you pick. For a loan installment, the loan's remaining balance goes down by the same amount.
- 🫳 `Save to Fund (Moves Cash)`: moves the amount from one account into a savings account, setting it aside without paying anyone yet. A Sinking Fund **1st Half** can only be saved to a fund.

Choose the account under **Take money from…** (and, for a fund, **Move to Savings…**), then click `Confirm Payment` or `Confirm Transfer`. If the account doesn't hold enough, Vault stops and tells you how much it needs.

When you pay a Sinking Fund **2nd Half (Due)** whose 1st Half was saved, Vault asks whether to auto-transfer the saved money first:

- **OK** moves the saved 1st Half from the fund into the account you're paying from, then pays the full amount.
- **Cancel** pays the full amount from your selected account and leaves the fund untouched.

True Bi-Monthly loans never show this prompt; each half pays only itself.

Split a recurring bill

Splitting lets you save for a big monthly bill, like rent or tuition, from both paychecks. It works exactly like a Sinking Fund loan:

- **Name (1st Half)** is due 15 days before the real due date and is saved to a fund.

- **Name (2nd Half (Due))** is due on the real due date and pays the full bill.

Split a new bill by ticking `Recurring` and then `Split into Bi-Monthly Halves`. The form then asks for the **Full Amount** and the **2nd Half Paycheck**; Vault picks the 1st Half's paycheck with the 10-day rule. To split an existing recurring bill, click its `Split` button.

For split bills, always type the **full bill amount**, both when entering a TBD amount and when editing. Vault puts half on each half, and shows "half of ₱X" under each. Every future month is split too: paying the 2nd Half creates next month's pair as TBD.

Move a bill to another paycheck

Click `Move`, then either pick an existing paycheck from the list or type any date, and click `Confirm Move`. Vault warns you if the new paycheck lands after the bill's due date. Only that occurrence moves; next month's copy of a recurring bill uses the normal 10-day rule again.

Receipts

Paid and funded bills appear under **Receipts (Paid & Settled Bills)**, newest first. Undoing a receipt:

- **A payment** refunds the full amount to the account it came from, puts the bill back, restores a loan's balance (reopening it if that payment had completed it), and removes next month's TBD copy if it was created automatically.
- **A Save to Fund** moves the money back from the savings account and puts the bill back. If some of the fund was already spent, Vault refuses and tells you how much is missing.

Recycle Bin

Deleted bills wait in **Recycle Bin (Deleted Bills)**. Click `Restore` to put one back in the Budget.

06 Loan Generator

Enter a loan once and Vault creates every installment as a bill in the Budget, already allocated to paychecks.

Choose an entry mode

- 🆕 `New Loan (Auto-Calculate)` : for a fresh loan. Enter the principal, interest rate, and duration, and Vault calculates the total and the monthly payment.
- 📋 `Existing Loan (Manual Entry)` : for a loan you're already paying. Type the remaining balance and the monthly payment exactly as your lender shows them.

How interest is calculated

INTEREST TYPE	TOTAL INTEREST	₱10,000 AT 3% FOR 6 MONTHS
`Flat (one-time)`	Principal × rate	₱300.00
`Per Month`	Principal × rate × months	₱1,800.00
`Per Year`	Principal × rate × months ÷ 12	₱150.00

Total Loan Incurred = principal + interest, and the monthly payment = total ÷ number of months. A green panel previews Total Interest, Total Loan Incurred, Per Month, and Per Bi-Monthly Half as you type.

Fill in the schedule

FIELD	MEANING
Duration	How many months or years the loan runs.
Preferred Schedule	`Monthly` (one installment per month) or `Bi-Monthly` (two halves per month).
Bi-Monthly Type	`Sinking Fund` or `True Bi-Monthly`. See Key ideas.
Set Your Paycheck Routine	Your two paydays as days of the month. Defaults are 15 and 30; use 30 or 31 for end of month.
Next Due Date	The next date the lender expects payment. For bi-monthly loans this is the 2nd Half's date.
Date Acquired	Optional. When you took out the loan, for your records.

Preview, adjust, and save

1. Click `+ Preview Draft Schedule`. Vault lists every installment with its due date, amount, and suggested paycheck.
2. Change any **Allocate to Paycheck** date you want to adjust.
3. Click `✅ Confirm & Save Loan`. Every installment appears in the Bi-Monthly Budget, named like **Loan (1st Half)**, **Loan (2nd Half (Due))**, or **Loan (Due Date)**.

Active, completed, and deleted loans

- **Active Loans** show each loan's principal and remaining balance. Click `View` for the full payment schedule; each installment is marked ✅ **Paid**, 📥 **Saved** (a 1st Half sitting in a fund), or *unpaid*.
- When a payment brings the remaining balance to zero, the loan moves to ✅ **Completed Loans** automatically and any leftover installments are cleared.
- `🗑️ Delete` moves a loan to the **Loan Recycle Bin** and removes its unpaid installments from the Budget. `↩️ Undo & Restore` brings it back and rebuilds its schedule using the paycheck routine currently entered on this screen.

> **GIVE LOANS DISTINCT NAMES**
>
> Deleting a loan removes unpaid bills whose names *start with* the loan's name. A loan called `Car` would also clear a bill called `Car Insurance`. Use names that don't overlap, like `Car Loan`.

07 Search

Pick what you're looking for first, then type. Results appear as you type, grouped by where they live.

CATEGORY	SEARCHES
🔎 `Everything`	Bill, receipt, and loan names; transaction descriptions and account names; and amounts, when you type a number.
🗓️ `Bills`	Unpaid bills and paid receipts, by name.
📉 `Loans`	Active and completed loans, by name.
💵 `Amount`	Bill amounts (including a half's full installment), loan figures (remaining, payment, per half, principal, total), and transaction amounts.

- **Whole numbers match any centavos.** `1500` finds everything from `₱1,500.00` to `₱1,500.99`; `1500.50` finds exactly `₱1,500.50`. Peso signs and commas are fine.
- **Word order doesn't matter.** `tuition loan` finds "Loan – Tuition". Capitals don't matter either.
- For amount matches, the result says *which* amount matched, e.g. "matched remaining" on a loan.
- Each group has an `Open ›` button that takes you to that screen.

Deleted items in the Recycle Bins aren't searched.

08 Step-by-step guides

Set up Vault for the first time

1. Unlock a vault with your profile name.
2. In **Cash Flow**, add each account you use and log an Income for its current balance (description: `Opening balance`).
3. Add a savings account to hold Sinking Fund money, e.g. `Loan Fund`.
4. In **Loan Generator**, add each loan. Use **Existing Loan (Manual Entry)** for loans you're already paying.
5. In **Bi-Monthly Budget**, add your bills, ticking **Recurring** for monthly ones.
6. Open the **Dashboard** and check that Total Liquid Cash matches your real balances.

Payday routine

1. In **Cash Flow**, log your salary as Income.
2. In **Bi-Monthly Budget**, open this paycheck's tab and compare **Total Tab Due** with your pay.
3. Enter any TBD amounts from your billing statements.
4. Handle each bill: **Pay Bank** for bills you're paying now, **Save to Fund** for Sinking Fund 1st Halves.
5. If the tab is short, use 🗓️ **Move** to shift a bill to the next paycheck, as long as it's still before the due date.

Pay a utility bill whose amount changes

1. Add it once as a **Recurring** bill, leaving the amount blank.
2. When the statement arrives, click `⚠️ TBD — Click to Enter Amount` and type it.
3. Handle the bill with **Pay Bank**. Next month's copy appears as TBD, ready for the next statement.

Fix a mistake

- **Wrong income, expense, or transfer:** undo it from the history in Cash Flow, then log it correctly.
- **Paid the wrong bill or from the wrong account:** undo the receipt in the Budget, then handle the bill again.
- **Deleted something by accident:** restore it from the matching Recycle Bin.

09 Your data & backups

Everything stays on your computer; Vault never sends your data anywhere. Each vault is one file:

`Documents\FinancialCommandCenter\<profile_name>_finance_data.db`

For example, the profile `Juan Dela Cruz` is saved as `juan_dela_cruz_finance_data.db`.

Back up

1. Close Vault.
2. Copy the whole `Documents\FinancialCommandCenter` folder to a USB drive or cloud storage.

Back up before installing a new version of Vault. New versions may add columns to your vault file the first time you log in; existing information is kept.

Restore or move to a new computer

1. Install Vault on the new computer.
2. Copy your backed-up `.db` file into `Documents\FinancialCommandCenter`, creating the folder if needed.
3. Open Vault and unlock it with the same profile name.

10 Troubleshooting

My vault is empty after logging in

You most likely typed a different profile name, which created a new empty vault. Click **Log Out** and unlock with the exact name you used before. Your data is still in its own file in `Documents\FinancialCommandCenter`.

A balance is off by ₱0.01

Versions before 0.2.0 could create or lose a centavo when moving Sinking Fund halves of odd-centavo installments (for example ₱412.35 ÷ 2 = ₱206.175). Version 0.2.0 fixes this for all new transactions.

Older differences can't be corrected automatically, because Vault can't know which side was right. Compare each account with your bank or e-wallet and log a small Income or Expense to match, with a description like `Rounding correction`.

"Insufficient funds!" when paying or transferring

The account you picked holds less than the payment. The message shows both amounts. Transfer money in from another account, or pick a different account. For a Sinking Fund 2nd Half, remember the payment is the full monthly amount.

The Handle Bill button is greyed out

The bill's amount is still TBD. Enter the amount first.

I can't delete an account

Accounts must be empty before they can be deleted. Transfer the remaining balance to another account first.

A transaction has no Undo button

Only the 3 most recent undoable entries show Undo; click **Show undo** on older ones. Bill payments and fund transfers are undone from Receipts in the Bi-Monthly Budget instead.

Undoing a Save to Fund says "Cannot undo!"

Some of the money has already left the savings account, often because it was auto-transferred to pay the 2nd Half. Undo that 2nd Half payment first, or move money back into the fund.

Numbers on a screen look out of date

Click 🔁 **Refresh** in the top bar.

What are the "advanced tools"?

Hidden maintenance buttons for data from older versions of the app. **Fix Stray Rounding** (Cash Flow) rounds every balance to whole centavos. **Repair Loan Links** (Loan Generator) reconnects old installments to their loans. Use them only once, after moving data from an old version.

11 Glossary

Allocation	The paycheck a bill is assigned to.
Paycheck tab	A tab in the Bi-Monthly Budget listing one paycheck's bills.
10-day safety gap	Vault's rule of allocating a bill to the latest payday at least 11 days before its due date.
1st Half / 2nd Half (Due)	The two parts of a monthly payment split across both paychecks. The 2nd Half falls on the real due date.
Sinking Fund	A bi-monthly loan or split bill where the 1st Half is saved and the 2nd Half pays the full amount.
True Bi-Monthly	A bi-monthly loan where each half is a real payment to the lender.
Fund	A savings account holding a 1st Half until the 2nd Half is paid.
Recurring	A bill that comes back on the same day every month.
Split bill	A recurring bill turned into a Sinking Fund pair.
TBD	A recurring bill whose amount hasn't been entered yet.
Receipt	The record of a paid or funded bill, which can be undone.
Total Loan Incurred	Principal plus all interest.
Vault	One profile's data file, or the app itself.
